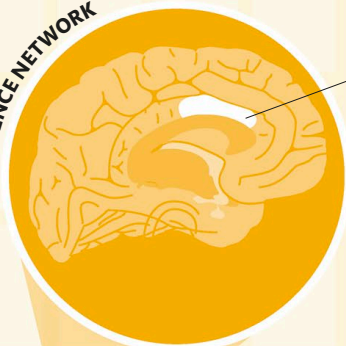




SALIENCE NETWORK



Recruits other networks based on information received

CENTRAL EXECUTIVE NETWORK



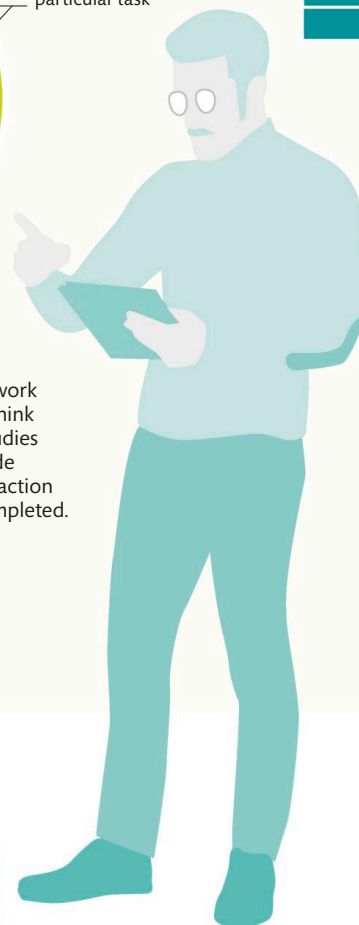
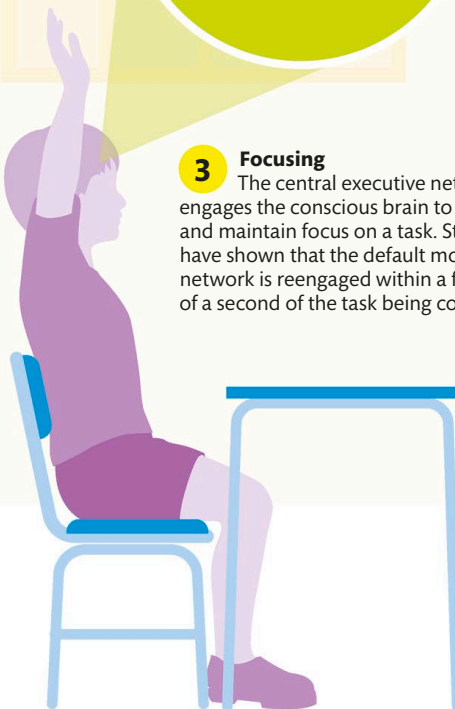
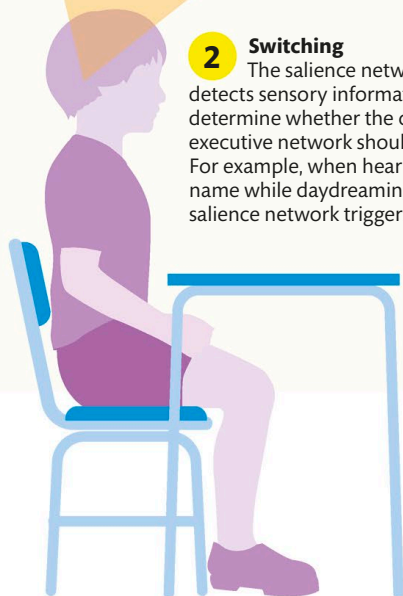
Regions activated to maintain attention on particular task

2 Switching

The salience network detects sensory information to determine whether the central executive network should engage. For example, when hearing your name while daydreaming, the salience network triggers a switch.

3 Focusing

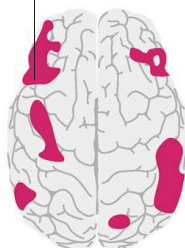
The central executive network engages the conscious brain to think and maintain focus on a task. Studies have shown that the default mode network is reengaged within a fraction of a second of the task being completed.



THE BRAIN ON JAZZ

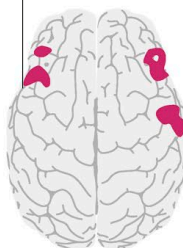
In one study, jazz musicians were asked to play the piano while in an fMRI machine. Their brain activity was recorded as they switched from playing memorized music to improvised jazz. The results showed that brain areas responsible for the evaluation of our own actions and inhibition were less active during improvisation.

Activity in the lateral prefrontal cortex



MEMORIZED MUSIC

Deactivation in lateral prefrontal cortex



IMPROVISED MUSIC

WHY DO IDEAS OFTEN FLOW WHEN WE ARE NOT FOCUSED ON A TASK?

The brain is particularly good at reconfiguring and connecting information when it is not in a task-orientated mode.